

Q Any reasons for not making Linux 3.8 a long-term kernel?

The 3.8 Linux kernel series is NOT going to be a long-term stable kernel release. I will NOT be maintaining it for a long time, and in fact, will stop maintaining it right after the 3.9 kernel is released. The 3.0 and 3.4 kernel releases are both long-term, and both are going to be maintained by me for at least two years. If I were to pick 3.8 right now, that would mean I would be maintaining three long-term kernels, plus whatever 'normal' stable kernels are happening at that time. That is something I cannot do without losing even more hair than I already have. It would be insane to even attempt to do so.

Q What are the top five Linux distributions, according to you?

How is someone supposed to 'rank' a Linux distribution? The reason there are so many distributions is that they are all targeted towards different usage models and audiences. Because of that, trying to rank them is meaningless.

Q What is it that the major Linux distributions are doing right and where do they fall short? What kind of contribution do you do to these distributions, if any?

Again, different distros have different goals and audiences. Judge them by how well they meet those goals. As for what I do for distros, I have been a Gentoo developer for a very long time, and I currently also maintain the Tumbleweed 'version' of openSUSE.

Q Microsoft is using the language of open source technology in recent times. It has also come up with an open source subsidiary. How do you view these efforts from the company?

I really have no idea, given that I do not interact with them in that manner. I do interact with the Linux kernel developers employed by Microsoft, and have known them for many years.

Q What are your preferred tools for software development?

I use Vim to edit files, Quilt for patch management, Git for source code control, and the kernel build tools (make, gcc, etc) for building kernels.

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Q What computer do you use?

Lots of different ones; it depends on where I am (travelling or at home), and what I am doing (build systems, test systems or remote systems).

Q What do you run on your desktop?

GNOME 3 with lots of terminal windows and a Web browser.

Q Any reasons for this choice?

It works well for me. My use of a desktop is quite limited — I only need a way to control a lot of terminal windows, and multiple desktops and monitors.

Q What do you think of Indian contributions to the open source projects in general and the Linux kernel in particular?

I really am not aware of where most developers live; so I cannot classify 'Indian contributions' at all. Sorry.

Q What do you think of the newest generation of kernel contributors? Do you see any star coming up, who can drive the progress of the kernel in the future?

We get new developers all the time, all of which is great to see. And yes, lots of them do wonderful work to help Linux progress. To single any one out would be unfair to those whom I would forget to list.

Q What is your take on Android and its success?

It's nice to see.  **END**

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